

Virtual University of Pakistan

ENG 512

Bilingualism

Final Term

Subjective

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1: Three characteristics of linguisticism?

1. Discrimination: Favours one language over others, leading to unfair treatment of people who speak different languages.
2. Language Hierarchy: Believing that some languages are superior and others are inferior.
3. Restricted Opportunities: Limiting access to education, jobs, or social services based on the language someone speaks.

2: Difference between adults and children in learning bilingual language:

Children and adults learn a bilingual language differently. Children learn languages quickly and naturally through play and talking with others. They tend to pick up native-like pronunciation easily. On the other hand, adults take more time to learn a new language and usually do so through formal classes and practice. They often retain an accent from their first language. While children learn because of their environment or school, adults are usually motivated by specific reasons like work or travel.

3: Flexible convergent arrangement:

In flexible convergent language use, aimed at encouraging a shift from one language to another, there are two common strategies:

1. Random Code-Switching: Frequently mixing two languages in conversation, which gradually leads to the dominance of the target language.
2. Monoliterate Bilingualism: Developing literacy (reading and writing) skills in only one language, encouraging its use over the other.

4. Need for Bilingual Languages in the 21st Century:

1. Global Communication: Helps in connecting with people from different countries.
2. Career Opportunities: Opens up more job options and can lead to better salaries.
3. Cultural Understanding: Promotes understanding and appreciation of different cultures.
4. Cognitive Benefits: Improves brain function, problem-solving skills, and multitasking.

5. Key Points for Scholars Preparing Bilingual Education Material:

1. Cultural Relevance: Ensure the material respects and reflects both cultures.
2. Language Balance: Provide equal focus on both languages to promote proficiency in each.
3. Engaging Content: Use interactive and interesting resources to keep students engaged.
4. Age Appropriateness: Tailor the material to be suitable for the age and developmental level of the learners.
5. Clear Instructions: Offer clear and concise explanations in both languages.
6. Support Resources: Include tools like glossaries and translations to aid understanding.
7. Inclusivity: Make sure the material is accessible to all students, regardless of their language background.

6. Two examples of "co-language" in a classroom setting:

1. Bilingual Presentations: Teachers use PowerPoint slides with text in both languages, such as English and Spanish. Each language is in a different colour, helping all students understand the material.
2. Subtitled Videos: A history teacher shows a documentary in English with subtitles in Spanish. This helps students who speak either language understand the content.

7. Characteristics of Co-language:

Using both languages at the same time, known as co-language, is increasingly common in education, especially in Africa. For instance, universities are integrating students who speak different languages by presenting curriculum materials in both Afrikaans and English on PowerPoint slides, using different colours for each language. This approach ensures inclusion of all students while respecting Afrikaans traditions. Co-language also occurs when teachers show videos in one language with subtitles in another, or when students use computer programs that support learning in different languages simultaneously. In primary classrooms, students may listen to books in two languages, sometimes switching between them as they learn.

8. Responsible Code-Switching:

Responsible code-switching means carefully managing language switching in the classroom to support the lesson, ensuring it is meaningful and not random. Most instruction should be in the main language being developed.

9. Time Allocation in bilingualism:

In bilingualism, time allocation refers to the distribution of time spent using and learning each language to ensure balanced development and proficiency in both languages.

10. Semilingualism:

Semilingualism in bilingualism refers to the idea that some bilingual individuals have limited proficiency in both of their languages, compared to monolingual speakers. This concept suggests that these individuals may struggle with language skills in both languages, rather

than being fully proficient in one or both.

11. Subtractive Bilingualism:

Subtractive bilingualism occurs when learning a second language leads to the loss or reduction of proficiency in the first language.

12. Three models of Bilingualism:

- 1.Subtractive Bilingualism
- 2.Additive Bilingualism
- 3.Recursive Bilingualism
- 4.Dynamic Bilingualism
- 5.Plurilingualism

13. This is why there is no consensus on the number of language in the world.

Languages are socially constructed. This is the reason why there is no consensus on the number of languages in the world. Any attempt to count distinct languages will be an artefact of classificatory procedures only. How a language is defined depends on the purpose one has in identifying a language.

14. UNESCO 1953 :

In 1953, UNESCO, responding to the educational failure of children in colonial situations, issued an important resolution declaring that it was axiomatic that a child be taught to read in their home language. Based on this principle, efforts to use the children's language in education, especially in the early grades, gained strength, leading to the first official uses of what has since been termed "transitional bilingual education," that is, the use of the child's heritage language in the early grades and only until the child is fluent in the majority or colonial language.

15. kindergarten learning language borrowing :

In an autonomous region of Italy, bilingual education for all was introduced at kindergarten in 1983, at primary school in 1988, and in the middle school (ages 10 to 13) in 1994, backed up by extensive research from Italian, French, and Swiss specialists. Teachers and learners alternate between languages in order to eliminate linguistic obstacles. By exploiting both languages intelligently and in a relaxed fashion for pedagogic reasons, teachers use code-switching effectively. The goal is not to teach code-switching, but to capitalize on its natural occurrence in order to transmit knowledge and skills.

16. How translanguaging help in bilingualism :

Translanguaging helps in bilingualism by allowing individuals to use their entire linguistic repertoire flexibly, enhancing communication, learning, and understanding. It promotes cognitive and linguistic development by enabling bilinguals to draw on all their language skills, supports identity and cultural expression, and improves engagement and

comprehension in educational settings.

17. Collaboration & Flexibility:

Collaboration in bilingualism means working together using both languages to support learning. Flexibility involves adapting language use based on context and needs, helping improve understanding and communication in various situations.

18. Equity of time :

Equity of time in bilingualism refers to the practice of distributing time equally between two languages in educational settings. This ensures that students have adequate opportunities to develop proficiency in both languages, promoting balanced bilingualism. It involves carefully planning lessons, activities, and interactions so that neither language is neglected, helping students achieve fluency and literacy in both.

19: Standardization process of language:

Standardization is not an inherent characteristic of language, but the result of a deliberate process. Standardization occurs by fixing and regulating such features as the spelling and the grammar of a language in dictionaries and grammar books which are then used for prescriptive teaching of the language.

20: Language revitalization:

The change from description of language shift situations to diagnosis and action is the purview of what Fishman (1991) has called Reversing Language Shift (RLS) and others have called language revitalization.

21: Flexibility multiplicity:

Flexibility multiplicity refers to the ability of language users to adapt and navigate multiple languages, dialects, and language varieties in a flexible and dynamic way. This concept acknowledges the complex and diverse nature of language use in multilingual contexts, where individuals switch between languages, blend language features, and adjust their language to suit different contexts and purposes. Flexibility multiplicity celebrates the creative and adaptive potential of language users, who draw on their linguistic repertoire to communicate effectively and negotiate meaning in a diverse and ever-changing world.

22: Pidgins and Creoles:

Pidgins:

Pidgins are defined by linguists as languages that come into being in contact situations, and are used by speakers with different language backgrounds to communicate, typically to trade or in plantation contexts.

Creoles:

When pidgins become nativized and standardized, and adopted as the language of the home by a majority of the population, they are known as creoles.

23: Five phenomena that cause change in Bilingualism.

Five phenomena that can cause change in bilingualism:

1. **Language Contact:** When speakers of different languages interact, it can lead to language convergence, borrowing, and code-switching, causing changes in language use and proficiency.
2. **Language Shift:** A shift in language use or preference, often driven by social, economic, or political factors, can lead to a decline in proficiency or a switch to a new language.
3. **Language Attrition:** Reduced use or exposure to a language can cause language loss or decline in proficiency, especially among immigrant communities or minority language groups.
4. **Language Convergence:** The blending of linguistic features from multiple languages, resulting in changes to grammar, vocabulary, or pronunciation.
5. **Language Emergence:** The creation of new language varieties or dialects, such as pidgins, creoles, or mixed languages, which can emerge as a result of language contact and cultural exchange.

These phenomena demonstrate that bilingualism is a dynamic and constantly evolving process, shaped by individual and societal factors.

24: Convergent teaching:

What characterizes convergent bilingual teaching is the use of the two languages concurrently in ways that subordinate one language to the other following a flexible convergent arrangement.

25: Immersion bilingual education:

Immersion bilingual education also uses a sliding bilingual allocation. In total immersion types, 100 percent of the time is initially allocated to the majority child's second language but the child's home language is increasingly used until the two languages are equally divided in a 50:50 relationship

26: Constructivist vs. Transmission:

Constructivist:

It is built on the conviction that learning should involve social negotiation and interaction with others in authentic contexts that are relevant to the learner.

Transmission:

Transmission pedagogy is built on a western empirical tradition which views knowledge as a separate from the knower and as a collection of facts and concepts.

27: Balanced Bilingualism:

Balanced bilingualism presents a picture of children and adults who are equally competent in two languages in all contexts and with all interlocutors.

28: Balanced Bilinguality:

Equal proficiency in both languages.

29: Monolinguality:

Monolinguality is more commonly found in economically dominant groups whereas the members of minority or subordinate groups tend to bilingual or multilingual.

30: Responsible Code switching:

Responsible code switching means to carefully control the quantity and quality of switching between languages in the classroom so as to serve the objective of the lesson.

31: Language shift:

Language shift is defined as the change from the use of one language to the use of another language cross generations; language attrition is a shift occurring within one individual.

32: Monoliterate Bilingualism:

This bilingual arrangement requires that literacy be reserved only for the dominant language. The local vernacular is never read or written; it is merely used to support understandings and instruction. An example of this monoliterate bilingual arrangement is the one used in Mali.

33: Translanguaging:

Translanguaging is an important practice among language minority children who serve as translators for their parents who do not speak the majority language.

34: Policy dimensions enterprise:

Focused on the linguistic dimension, the three dimensions of the language policy (LP) enterprise are

1. **Corpus planning:** Changing the form of the language itself through standardization (standardizing language forms), graphization (developing a writing system), modernization (coining new words and terms).
2. **Status planning:** Modifying the status and prestige of the language.
3. **Acquisition planning:** Developing new users of the language. Acquisition planning is especially relevant to those of us interested in bilingual education because school is the most important agent in acquisition planning.

35: History of bilingualism:

The history of bilingualism is extensive and complex, reflecting the dynamic nature of human societies and their languages. Bilingualism dates back to ancient civilizations. In regions like Mesopotamia, Egypt etc often spoke multiple languages due to trade, conquest, and cultural exchange.

During the medieval period, bilingualism was common among the educated elite, who often knew Latin alongside their vernacular languages.

The age of exploration and colonization from the 15th to the 19th centuries brought about significant language contact. European colonizers, including the Spanish, Portuguese, French, and British, spread their languages to the Americas, Africa, and Asia.

The 19th and 20th centuries saw increased global migration and urbanization, leading to greater language contact and bilingualism.

Today, bilingualism is prevalent worldwide, driven by factors such as globalization, technology, and education. Many countries have bilingual or multilingual policies in place.